

Part 2: A DISAGREEMENT YOU HAD WITH SOMEONE

I once had a disagreement with the parent of one of my students. It was about **the child's progress and how they expected results almost overnight.**

The parent was convinced that their son wasn't improving fast enough, even though I could clearly see consistent growth - not dramatic, but steady. They believed I should push harder, give more homework, and use a stricter approach. I disagreed because I knew that pressure kills motivation, especially for younger learners.

During the conversation, they raised their voice a little, clearly frustrated. I stayed calm but firm. I explained the logic behind my teaching method - gradual skill-building instead of short-term memorization. It wasn't a pleasant talk, but I didn't let it get emotional.

Later that week, I sent them a detailed report showing their child's progress across different skills. Once they saw it visually, the tension dropped. They actually apologized and thanked me for my patience.

I felt relieved, not because I "won" the argument, but because I handled it like an adult. It reminded me that disagreement isn't a failure of communication - it's a test of control, and in teaching, control matters as much as knowledge.

PART 3: 1. How can we stop an argument from escalating into a fight?

The first step is to recognize when it's no longer about the topic but about *ego*. Most fights start when someone feels unheard or disrespected. So, instead of proving a point, focus on keeping the atmosphere calm - lower your tone, pause before responding, and show you're listening. Once people feel acknowledged, they usually stop attacking. I've learned that control over your emotions is more powerful than any argument you could win. A calm tone can defuse tension faster than logic ever could.

2. Why do some people avoid arguing with others?

Some people simply hate conflict. It drains them emotionally, or they've learned that most arguments go nowhere. Others avoid it because of personality - they prefer harmony and would rather let things go than engage in confrontation. But in my opinion, avoiding every disagreement isn't healthy either. It builds quiet resentment. The key is balance - you should know *which*

issues are worth addressing and *which* ones you can let slide. Not every hill is worth dying on.

3. Who do you think should teach children to respect their teacher?

It definitely starts at home. Respect isn't something a teacher can demand; it has to be modeled by parents. When a child hears their parents speak respectfully about teachers, it shapes how they behave in class. Of course, teachers have a role too - they must earn that respect through fairness, consistency, and empathy. But if a student grows up seeing adults talk negatively about education, no teacher can undo that mindset. So, it's a shared responsibility - parents set the foundation, teachers reinforce it.

4. How do we show respect to others when we disagree with them?

You show respect by separating the *idea* from the *person*. Attack the logic, not the individual. It's also about body language - don't roll your eyes, don't interrupt, don't raise your voice. Even small gestures communicate whether you value someone's opinion. Personally, when I disagree, I ask questions instead of firing statements. That way, it feels like a discussion, not a debate. Real maturity is being able to challenge someone's idea without trying to humiliate them.

5. What do you do if you disagree with someone?

I try to assess what kind of disagreement it is. If it's emotional or personal, I take a step back - timing matters more than being right. If it's professional, I stay factual and calm, present evidence, and make my point clearly. I've learned that people remember how you made them *feel* more than what you said, so I try to disagree without hostility. And if I realize I was wrong, I admit it. That honesty usually earns more respect than pretending to be perfect.

6. What disagreements do parents and children usually have?

Most revolve around independence - how much freedom a child should have versus how much control a parent wants to keep. Parents often think they're protecting their kids, but from the child's perspective, it feels like restriction. Then there's lifestyle: career choices, curfews, social media, even fashion. What's really happening beneath all that is a communication gap - both sides want the same thing, security and happiness, but they define it differently. I

think when both sides learn to *listen without trying to win*, the relationship becomes a lot stronger.